

below to make the character walk. For this, you will first need to draw the character in different phases of the walk cycle.

In the next step, you need to get the image on the Adobe Photoshop domain. Make sure that the basic body structure follows a plus top-level character main group structure, with the head group on the top, followed by the body group below. The image should be split up into multiple layers that you have to animate to give a realistic feel of the walk. Different parts need to be animated – head and upper body, the arms, legs, and the shadow. Within this framework, too, you need to group each part separately – right arm, left arm, right leg, left leg, and the torso.

Another important thing that you need to pay attention to is that all the body parts are in a straight line. Before you start to animate the character in the walking cycle, ensure that the character is in its default walking position. It is good to start with the side profile of the character, and once you gain confidence, you can move onto the front and back profiles.

The next thing to do is to de-group or make the groups independent. This is done by adding a plus symbol to each group name. This is done to remove all possible conflicts between the different groups when the character is made to walk. The different body parts will now be able to move on their own. Now, save this as a PSD file. Open Adobe Animate and import the saved PSD file. To summarise, in this step, we learned to prepare the character to walk.

Adding walk properties to body groups

When you open the character image in Adobe Animate, you will notice that the workspace looks similar to Photoshop with many added tools for the animation. First, select the top-level of the image to view the current behaviours in the properties panel. Adobe Animate adds these behaviours automatically to every image that is imported. The behaviours are meant for basic movements like head and eye movement, and lip sync. Click on the plus buttons against each movement and select 'Walk'. You will notice that some set behaviours get added.

So, now we will start adding handles to the main areas and naming them as body parts. The Handle tool needs to be used for the Animator to understand how to go about animating the different parts. Select the body groups from the layers list. Now, use the Handle tool to select a single group, starting from the belly button.

You will notice the right property will display the tag spin and a body section. You need to select the middle dot and tag it as 'waist'. Repeat the process to select another point below the waist and tag it as 'hip'.